

You are invited to

A Knight of Murder

Hear ye! Hear ye!

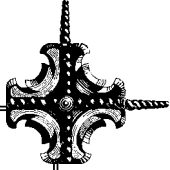
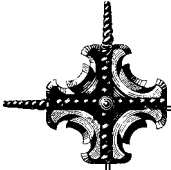
All ye Kings and Queens,
Knights and Nobles!

A tournament celebration is planned to honor the noble marriage of Baron Bartholomew to Lady Diana of Dunnsberry in the manor of Fernwood. As a resident of the manor, you are not only invited to be there, but your attendance is required by the request of your lord.

Whether it is to see a joust between two knights or partake in the ale and entertainment, your business is but your own... that is until you find yourself in the middle of a murder.

With only one night to find the guilty, you will soon figure out that there is a lot more at stake, for murder in the manor is punishable by death. Whether you are guilty or not, there will be others trying to finger you as the culprit as you try to find the real murderer, and only you can defend your innocence. Who do you trust? Who will betray you before the night is through? Everyone is a suspect and no one is safe in this mystery of medieval madness.

Be careful in attending. Your life will depend not only on your innocence, but your ability to defend it.



Join us for an evening of mystery & mayhem in the Middle Ages

Rules in the Manor of Fernwood

Whether this is your first murder mystery experience or your fortieth, each murder mystery experience is different and has different rules pertaining. Here are some tips to make sure this evening is an unforgettable experience.

Read Your Character Sheet—This contains your identity and all the information you will need to play your part.

Don't Reveal Everything About Your Character—While there are many things that everyone needs to know about you, there are some things that should remain secret. Use your discretion to not give too much away-- you may find out at the party that you are the killer indeed!

Dress The Part— It's a proven fact that the more into character you are the easier it will be for you to truly enjoy all the aspects of the night. It also adds to the excitement, the photo opps, and your chance to be voted best dressed. Please see the "party extras" section at www.nightofmystery.com for ideas on costuming.

Review the Announcements—Included in this invite will be manor announcements. Review this page, it includes background information (such as the other characters attending), which may come in useful the night of the party.

Use Your Money Creatively—Upon arrival, you will receive gold coins to spend any way you choose. Bribery and blackmail are two of the most common uses we found (and highly encouraged). The wealthiest player at the end of the night will also receive an award for their ability to turn a profit.

Hear Ye! Hear Ye!

It is by decree of the lord and lady of Fernwood that the people of the manor are invited and ordered to attend the noble marriage of their son, **Baron Bartholomew**, to **Lady Diana of Dunnsberry**. The wedding is to take place on **December Second**, the one year anniversary of their meeting. A tournament of jousting pleasure is to follow to commemorate this momentous occasion in which the victorious knight will be awarded many riches plus the lady of his choice as escort for the celebration that night. Those expected to be in attendance are as follows:

King Kyle: The ruler of this prosperous kingdom. He is well liked by everyone. It's hard to have many enemies when the punishment of betrayal is death!

Queen Genevieve: Wife of King Kyle. She rules equally alongside her king.

Sheriff: The king's official in Fernwood. He is in charge of collecting the taxes in the manor, which have been dwindling even though prosperity seems to be at its highest.

Lord Taylor: He runs the manor happily with Lady Gwendolyn. He is throwing the tournament in celebration of his only son's marriage to the noble woman of his choosing.

Lady Gwendolyn: Runs the manor lands with her husband Lord Taylor. She is delighted for the tournament, it means prosperity and happiness & the marriage of her only son to another noble.

Baron Bartholomew: The son of Lord Taylor and Lady Gwendolyn. The tournament is planned in honor of his marriage to another noble on the one year anniversary of their meeting. His only regret is that he must marry for wealth and not for love.

Lady Diana of Dunnsberry: Noble woman of Dunnsberry, she arrived in Fernwood in search of a husband that she found, but at the cost of breaking up one true love.

Maid Monica: She is the one who always caught the baron's eye (and heart). Since the baron's engagement

has been set with another woman, some say Monica has turned rather ruthless.

Maid Marilyn: Lady Gwendolyn's lady-in-waiting. Maid Marilyn is like a daughter to the lady and knows her lady will do anything for her happiness.

Sir Rufus: Sir Rufus is a relatively new knight to the manor and does not have as favorable of a reputation as Sir Cameron. He is hoping to increase his popularity with a victory over Sir Cameron in the tournament.

Sir Cameron: A gallant knight who is entertaining and fighting for his honor in the manor tournament. Word is that if he wins, he will be asking for the favor of Maid Marilyn.

Gallant Gary: Squire to Sir Cameron. He will do anything for his knight, Sir Cameron. Gary must prove valor, loyalty and honor in order to gain knighthood.

Charlamagne: As chambermaid, she is the lowest of the servants to live in the castle. Charlamagne knows the castle in and out and has seen a lot. Her access to all of the castle may also be what gets her into trouble.

Poor Pearl: A peasant woman whose small earnings have grown even smaller since the sheriff has been enforcing the laws in the manor.

William the Watchman: As the manor watchman, he is the security for the lord and his manor lands. He is sure to be the enforcer if anyone gets out of hand at the tournament.

Anyone not attending the wedding and celebration will be considered a traitor to the lord and lady and will be banished from the manor.

Laws of the Land

As set forth by King Kyle on how his kingdom is to be ruled

I. Betrayal of the king or queen is punishable by death!!!

II. The lord's word is law in his manor

- a. The only person that can overrule a lord is the king.
- b. A manor consists of a castle, church and the surrounding lands granted to the lord by the king or queen.

III. Everyone that makes earnings, must tithe a percentage of their earnings to the king

- a. Percentages are set by the king or queen .
- b. Tithes (taxes) are collected by the sheriff in compliance with the wishes of the king or queen.

IV. The manor is to be run with a system as follows:

- a. Lords & Ladies—granted land from the king and may run the manor as they see fit. They award land to the vassals and knights in exchange for protection from invaders. Among their duties are arranging marriages within their manor and administering justice.
- b. Vassals & Knights—are awarded land from the nobles of the manor. They are free to farm the land or pay peasants to do so. They may also have serfs that live on and farm their land.
- c. Peasants—often live in huts outside the castle walls and work on land owned by vassals or knights for a percentage of the profits. They still have their freedom, but own no land.
- d. Serfs—they are slaves to the lord for life. They farm the land for food and shelter, they are not allowed to have earthly possessions and in order to gain any freedom, they must escape and live one year plus one day in another manor. They are never required to fight, but are guaranteed protection from invaders. They need permission to marry.

V. Tournaments are to be a time of great celebration

- a. To be held to honor such events as coronation, a noble marriage or to boost the economy of a manor.
- b. The victorious knight may request the favor of any lady at the celebration. She will then be his escort for the evening.

Poor Pearl

You are a peasant woman on the manor of Fernwood. By being a peasant, you are a step above the serfs in that you are not a slave to the land, but rather you work on the land of the vassals in exchange for food and money. Still, your place in society is rather low.

You fear that your place in society is so low in fact that you know that you will probably never get to marry your true love, Gary Gallant. Gary is a squire to Sir Cameron and lives in the castle. Since he is above you in social status, you know that marrying a knight is probably not in your future, but the two of you are in love. Earlier today, you met Gary in the stables before the tournament to steal some kisses. While in the stables, you saw Sir Rufus, who looked like he was up to no good.

You do not like or trust Sir Rufus. Recently, the king has raised the taxes from 10% of your earnings to 15%. When you told the sheriff (who is in charge of collecting the taxes in Fernwood) that you would not be able to pay that much in taxes and still survive, he responded that your family would not survive if you DID NOT pay the full amount. Soon thereafter Sir Rufus threatened members of your family with his sword.

You have told Gary Gallant this, but you have also made Gary promise not to tell anyone. You fear for the lives of your family if Sir Rufus or the sheriff were ever to find out that it was you who was telling others about their treacherous ways.

You are very excited about the upcoming tournament. The tournament is being thrown in honor of a noble marriage and it should be a joyous time for all in the manor. It is another reason to celebrate and be with your true love, Gary Gallant. You hope that you can avoid seeing Sir Rufus or the sheriff, for they both make you shutter with fear.

Acting and Dressing Your Part: You are a poor peasant woman. You are humble and very sweet. You know that it is your place to serve others, so you delight in doing so. You do not have a lot of riches, so your dress should reflect that. *For ideas on costumes and accessories, please see the "Party Extras" section at www.nightofmystery.com*